



Notes

Aug 18, 2026

Agent Ecosystem Working Group 2: Agent Adoption and Operations - MACH Alliance

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Attachments  Agent Ecosystem Working Group 2: Agent Adoption and Operations...

Meeting records  Transcript

Summary

The meeting explored Artificial Intelligence Return on Investment frameworks and defined the strategic direction for white papers.

Enterprise Artificial Intelligence Metrics

Presenters shared a conceptual Return on Investment framework using DevOps Research and Assessment data to measure agent productivity. Stakeholders suggested partitioning the content to address broader business use cases beyond software development.

White Paper Strategy Development

Discussions centered on creating a guide for technical business leaders to govern agent proliferation and manage cultural readiness. The consensus was to frame the document around diagnostic tools for leadership rather than technical code implementation.

Vendor Costs and Adoption

Participants expressed concern over the high cost and unclear returns of Artificial Intelligence licensing models. The group agreed to proceed with drafting a white paper brief based on today's strategic discussions.

Decisions

Aligned

- **Initial content scope defined** The group agreed to limit the scope of the initial white paper version (V1) to software engineering to ensure content digestibility, while keeping plans for future expansion to other business roles.
- **Governance and assurance discussion deferred** The team agreed to table the assurance and governance discussion until the next session to prioritize the white paper brainstorming agenda.
- **White paper target audience confirmed** The group established that the primary target audience for the white paper is the business-facing leader (CIO-persona) with a technical background, rather than targeting enterprise architects or pure software developers.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: [Helpful](#) or [Not Helpful](#)

Next steps

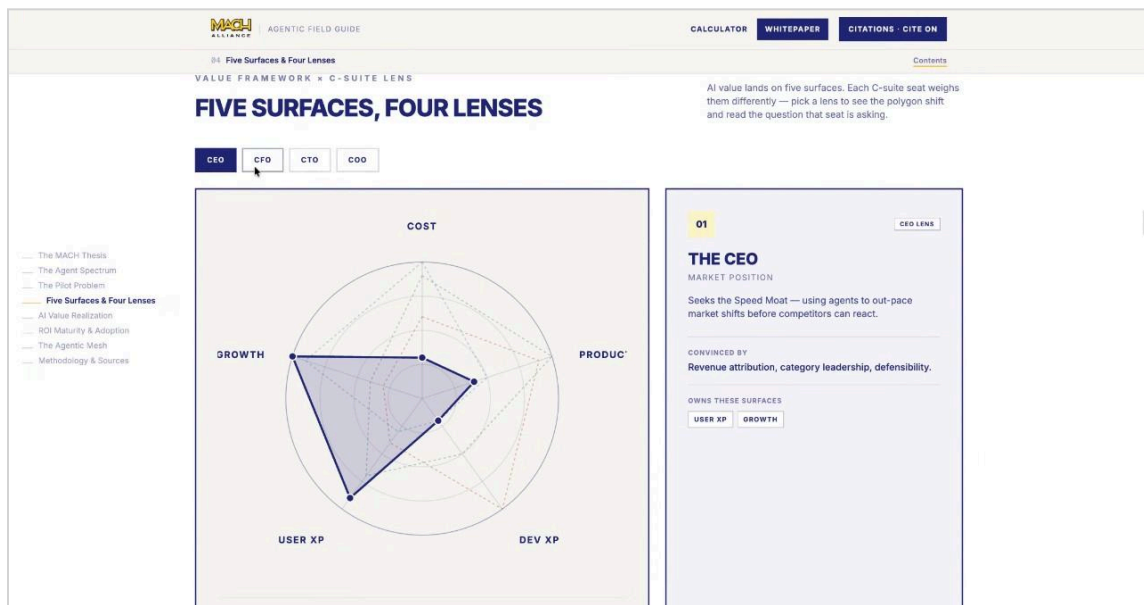
- ☐ [Rebecca Lyus] Upload Notes: Upload the latest meeting notes to GitHub.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt, Rebecca Lyus, Andrew Kumar] Coordinate ROI Calculator: Sync on the next steps for the enterprise ROI calculator and coordinate with the marketing team.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt] Onboard New Member: Reach out to Petro on Slack to explain the working group history and current focus.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt] Draft White Paper: Analyze the meeting transcript to create a brief outlining the white paper.
- ☐ [Everett Zufelt] Draft Brief: Compile meeting notes into a project brief. Post the document to the Slack channel.
- ☐ [The group] Review Brief: Challenge, question, and comment on the draft brief. Prepare the content for further progress.

Details

Did the screenshots in this section make your notes [better](#) or [worse](#)?

- **Meeting Opening and Agenda:** Everett Zufelt opened the meeting by confirming that the session would be recorded and transcribed ([00:03:07](#)). The agenda included a presentation by Andrew Kumar regarding Enterprise Artificial Intelligence Return on Investment (ROI) and metrics, a discussion on assurance and governance, and a facilitated strategy session regarding a future white paper ([00:04:10](#)).
- **Presentation - Enterprise AI ROI Calculator:** Andrew Kumar presented an Enterprise AI ROI calculator and conceptual framework, which synthesizes data from the MACH Alliance Enterprise Agent Architecture working group and the DevOps Research and Assessment (DORA) report ([00:07:15](#)). The tool helps

users input organizational variables such as headcount, salary, and current AI adoption phase—ranging from pilot to enterprise-wide—to estimate productivity multipliers and gross annual value (00:09:06). The model adjusts metrics based on stakeholder roles, providing specific views for Chief Executive Officers, Chief Operating Officers, Chief Technology Officers, and Chief Financial Officers (00:08:10). Andrew Kumar explained that the tool includes visualizations of AI impact, maturity models on the agent spectrum, and documentation of friction points associated with agent deployment (00:11:50).



- Feedback on ROI Presentation:** Dylan Valade and Jessica Dvoretz commended the presentation, noting that it effectively visualizes complex ROI concepts for various organizational functions. The group suggested that the substantial amount of content might be better served by splitting it into multiple distinct pieces of content rather than a single document (00:15:45). Jessica Dvoretz raised questions about extending the scope of the framework beyond software development to address broader business use cases, noting the challenge of finding available data for non-technical roles (00:17:04).



- Data Methodology and Unique Value:** Ryan Lunka emphasized the necessity for the MACH alliance to develop a unique, opinionated framework for ROI rather than primarily restating existing analysis from sources like the DORA report (00:20:03). Andrew Kumar clarified that the framework is currently software-focused due to data availability but remains generalizable if new data sources are identified (00:19:11). The group discussed the potential for partnering with Google to officially leverage and promote the DORA report data within their work (00:22:54).
- Introduction of New Member and Working Group Mandate:** Rebecca Lyus introduced Petro Vaxevanakis, the head of marketing at Ocula Technologies, to the group (00:25:53). Everett Zufelt provided an overview of the Agent Adoption and Operations working group, explaining that their mandate is to help organizations understand the operational and cultural changes necessary to capture value from AI agents after they are deployed (00:28:00).
- White Paper Thesis Formulation:** Everett Zufelt initiated a brainstorming session regarding the thesis of the upcoming white paper (00:29:12). The discussion highlighted ambiguity regarding whether the document should advocate for limiting agents to ensure quality or prepare organizations for the inevitability of managing hundreds or thousands of agents (00:30:13). Itay Droog argued that the focus should be on data governance, noting that any organization providing tools for staff to create agents will inevitably face a

proliferation of systems that require strict management of data access and external connectivity ([00:31:46](#)).

- **Refining Agent Terminology:** Ryan Lunka challenged the binary definition of an "agent," suggesting it creates confusion because the term does not refer to a distinct technical category but rather a spectrum or a quality of software deliverables ([00:32:54](#)) ([00:36:23](#)). Everett Zufelt agreed, characterizing this as the "quality of agency" that systems now possess, which introduces both governance risks and value opportunities for enterprises ([00:35:16](#)).
- **Identifying the Target Audience and Hook:** The group discussed the appropriate hook and target persona for the white paper. Jessica Dvoretz suggested that a provocative question regarding whether leaders actually know the number and function of agents in their organization could be an effective engagement tool ([00:37:52](#)) ([00:40:05](#)). The group identified the primary persona as a business leader with a technical background—such as a Chief Information Officer—who faces pressure to innovate but lacks specific knowledge on how to govern agentic systems ([00:40:05](#)).
- **Enablement and Influence:** Ryan Lunka, Dylan Valade, and Tim Fernihough noted that this persona needs to be educated to effectively influence internal stakeholders and push back against unrealistic expectations from boards or executive leadership ([00:40:05](#)) ([00:42:46](#)). The goal of the white paper is to provide these leaders with the language and framework to navigate these conversations confidently, rather than offering code snippets or purely technical guidance ([00:41:33](#)) ([00:45:10](#)).
- **Business Value and Organizational Drivers:** Dylan Valade discussed the business rationale for the white paper, explaining that while existential threats are not always immediate, organizations are seeking levers to increase autonomy, improve margins, and drive growth ([00:46:43](#)). The group discussed using the DORA data set to demonstrate that high-performing organizations exhibit consistent behaviors that lead to positive business outcomes, regardless of whether they automate processes manually or via AI agents ([00:48:05](#)).
- **Risk and Organizational Pressure:** Jessica Dvoretz and Everett Zufelt highlighted the "personal existential threat" facing leaders who feel pressure from boards to build internal solutions rather than purchasing Software as a Service products ([00:50:38](#)). Ryan Lunka suggested incorporating concepts from Clayton Christensen's "Innovator's Dilemma" to help readers distinguish

between sustaining and disruptive innovations, as the required strategic actions differ significantly based on that classification ([00:51:44](#)) ([00:54:58](#)).

- **Organizational Culture and Readiness:** Dylan Valade argued that the white paper must address organizational culture, as successful agent adoption requires an environment ready for change. The group emphasized that leaders must be able to diagnose why previous technology adoption efforts, such as implementing a new Customer Relationship Management system, may have failed, as this provides insight into the challenges they will face when implementing AI agents ([00:56:16](#)).
- **Co-pilot Licensing and ROI Concerns:** Everett Zufelt raises concerns regarding the company's \$1 million annual expenditure on Co-pilot, questioning whether the investment is providing a justifiable return, potentially up to \$5 million. They express uncertainty regarding user adoption rates and the effectiveness of current usage. Jessica Dvoretz agrees with the sentiment of "sticker shock" and highlights the difficulty of ensuring value realization when managing both internal pressure to provide licenses and the associated costs. Additionally, Everett Zufelt touches upon the cultural anxiety surrounding AI adoption, specifically the fear regarding job security and future employability ([00:58:30](#)).
- **AI Vendor Pricing and Market Dynamics:** Everett Zufelt discusses the strategic pricing models utilized by AI vendors, specifically noting that Anthropic's 50% usage boost is set to expire, which would result in a 50% overage cost for users who wish to maintain their current workflows. Both Everett Zufelt and Jessica Dvoretz observe that vendors are effectively extracting value from clients and note that as these companies move toward public offerings, pricing structures are likely to become increasingly expensive ([00:59:35](#)).
- **White Paper Development and Meeting Conclusion:** Everett Zufelt outlines the next steps, stating they will review the transcript, synthesize the notes, and prepare a brief for a white paper. This draft will be shared in the Slack channel within the next few days for the team to review, challenge, and comment on, with the goal of finalizing the direction for the project. The meeting concludes with Dylan Valade, Rebecca Lyus, and Petro Vaxevanakis expressing appreciation for the discussion ([00:59:35](#)).

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Transcript

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00:00:12

Rebecca Lyus: Hello.

Ryan Lunka: Yes.

Dylan Valade: Hello. Good

Rebecca Lyus: Morning.

Dylan Valade: morning.

Rebecca Lyus: All

Everett Zufelt: Hello

Rebecca Lyus: right, I say we give it a couple more minutes,

Everett Zufelt: everyone.

Rebecca Lyus: let a couple more people trickle in and then we can get

Everett Zufelt: Yeah,

Rebecca Lyus: underway.

Everett Zufelt: lovely. I feel like summer ended somehow at my house and I didn't get the memo. It's like in the teens here Celsius today and I want it to be

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: 30s

Dylan Valade: It's

Rebecca Lyus: I'm I'm enjoying the lower temperature.

Dylan Valade: so

Ryan Lunka: The American in the room has no idea what you're talking

Everett Zufelt: 60s uh 60s at my high high 60s low 70s at my house

Ryan Lunka: about.

Everett Zufelt: today and that's not August.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah,

Dylan Valade: the 82. Uh that was uh my anchor on the Celsius

Everett Zufelt: There. There you go. Yeah.

Dylan Valade: Fahrenheit.

Rebecca Lyus: we had a uh terrifying moment I think over the weekend where we got a national alarm come on our phone for the heat which basically is a bomb warning in the UK that if there's any issues that's the alarm that will go off and they used it for wildfires and like all of the UK just had a freak out cuz they were like please don't use the temporary barbecues.

00:02:15

Rebecca Lyus: It's like, oh god, we thought this was a different.

Ryan Lunka: We we just had the opposite scenario.

Everett Zufelt: That's like

Ryan Lunka: We have um I live on like the edge of a part of the country that can get some tornadoes like we're

Dylan Valade: different

Rebecca Lyus: Oh.

Ryan Lunka: like the very edge of tornado alley and so they set off um tornado alarms across the

Dylan Valade: bike.

Ryan Lunka: whole county every week like to test them and so you hear them pretty regularly.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Ryan Lunka: We actually had a tornado last week and it didn't go off.

Everett Zufelt: Uh,

Ryan Lunka: He's like, "What the

Rebecca Lyus: Oh, god.

Everett Zufelt: I I have the same problem.

Ryan Lunka: hell?

Everett Zufelt: I'm at like like Canada's northeest point of tornado valley and we'll get like a tornado alarm for like a tornado three counties away. And I'm like, I I think it's important to tell people there's a tornado, but I probably don't need to know about one that's so far away from me.

Ryan Lunka: Boy, you

Everett Zufelt: It's it's sunny outside and I'm in my pool and my phone's going off saying there's a tornado

00:03:07

Ryan Lunka: cried.

Everett Zufelt: coming. Yeah.

Ryan Lunka: Yep.

Everett Zufelt: Or the thing in Hawaii last year, was it? The false alarm in Hawaii.

Rebecca Lyus: Yes.

Everett Zufelt: Oh my god.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah, it was essentially one of those alarms, but uh saying please don't use temporary barbecues, which is quite a drastic approach.

Everett Zufelt: Rebecca will never barbecue anything again.

Rebecca Lyus: Um,

Everett Zufelt: Just just in case.

Rebecca Lyus: no, no, too traumatized. Too traumatized to barbecue given this

Everett Zufelt: Well, I think we probably we probably have quorum here.

Rebecca Lyus: heat.

Everett Zufelt: Thanks everybody for jumping on. I'm hoping everybody will be because I think we're going to talk through three things today that then folks are going to rush off and and go create and or edit some documents. I I'd love to get folks permission if we don't already have it to record the call today like the transcript

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: especially if we can.

Rebecca Lyus: it be recorded.

Everett Zufelt: Perfect. Do we have the transcript turned on as well, Rebecca?

00:04:10

Rebecca Lyus: We do indeed.

Everett Zufelt: Love

Rebecca Lyus: I I have that up.

Everett Zufelt: it.

Rebecca Lyus: I just need to upload the latest notes while I was out onto GitHub.

Everett Zufelt: Perfect.

Rebecca Lyus: But previous GitHub notes will be on

Everett Zufelt: Lovely. So, what I what I proposed for today is we we this one's been dragging a little bit because of the summer and people being

Rebecca Lyus: there.

Everett Zufelt: unavailable, but uh Andrew's put together some thoughts. Uh I think they're quite good. I think Ryan gave some feedback already and there's a re revision uh Andrew that you've done, but I'd love to to spend maybe 10 minutes or so just kind of Andrew kind of presenting uh what you've put together, maybe gather some perspectives and feedback. Uh the second item then is uh Ryan and Tim and I have

started to put together some thoughts around what does assurance and governance look like? Uh maybe just share that with the group and get some feedback there. And then hopefully th those two take about 20 minutes together.

00:05:06

Everett Zufelt: And then when we had our call last week, uh we talked about how can we start sourcing ideas for a white paper more around the strategy, vision, value, ROI piece, uh and maybe do for, you know, 20 or 30 minutes do a bit of a facilitated exercise. I'll put on my I'll put on my indifferent facilitator hat uh and uh maybe help to get all of our ideas out and then come back to folks with a bit of a straw man for what that white paper outline could look like. Um so that's what I I was proposing we work through today. Does that make sense? Does that work for everybody?

Dylan Valade: Definitely the person with the

Everett Zufelt: Awesome. So maybe we'll start by hand it over to Andrew.

Dylan Valade: PL

Andrew Kumar: Okay, actually I need one moment. I'm loading up the spinning up the environment. Inference. Okay, let's see if this works. Can you all see my screen?

Dylan Valade: Yep, looks good.

Andrew Kumar: Okay,

Rebecca Lyus: Yep.

Andrew Kumar: fantastic.

00:07:15

Andrew Kumar: So, coming coming out of one of the previous meetings, I feel like it was a couple weeks ago when I uh when I kicked off this and I think we may have even been in a meeting when I when I started this um using so Ryan shared some resources

around the door metric. So, thank you very much uh Ryan. Um and then also um I think Ryan commented and shared some some more documentation on the um it was what the other working group had put together. Um, so using those two inputs as a source. Um, and I have something around citations in here somewhere. Uh, credits and sources. Yeah. So there's the MACH alliance enterprise agent architecture working group. So they provided some blog post and material there and then the DORA ROI of AIS and software development. So those are two sources. So putting those sources together um to and leveraging the data from those two sources adding a bit of more of a MACH composable angle and spin to create two things.

00:08:10

Andrew Kumar: one is an enterprise ROI calculator. Um, so you know there's I I you know don't I didn't create all the copy on this. This is very much AI assisted but putting a I I did approve of this one putting a defensible number on enterprise AI. Um and there's a bit of a model on how to approach and how to calculate the ROI. And then there's a whole bunch of data. It's kind of a synthesis of data from those other two to three sources um around from agent definition to responsible ROI. So there's a MACH thesis um around but first I'll get into the calculator then I'll come back to the white paper. So the calculator does a couple things. First thing is understanding the length because the metrics are the same just the presentation changes. So you can see if you're a CEO it's looking at something like revenue attribution. Um, if you're a COO, you're looking cycle time reduction. If you're a CTO, you're looking at developer velocity. If you're a CFO, you're looking at the net annual value.

00:09:06

Andrew Kumar: So, you have just the math the same, but the leading metrics kind of change. Um, so that's kind of the first step. So, say I'm a, you know, a CTO and then where am I today? So, am I in the pilot phase? Am I scaled and am I enterprisewide? So,

this kind of changes a bit of the lift. So, I'm in a pilot pilot. So, it kind of does an estimation on productivity lift. So you pick the stage that matches how far AI is embedded in your organization in the current state. So I might say I'm in pilot phase now. So it's pilot phase is anything in this 3 point 3% to 8% range. Um but I can also then fine-tune it so that I can say actually you know what we're super early or if I look at someone like some of my previous employers it's like enterprisewide and basically you know 50 to 50 plus percent of the organizations already using AI. So I can fine-tune it that way.

00:09:56

Andrew Kumar: Um, and then the numbers, right? What is the headcount of of that organization? Um, so say I'm going to fine-tune it and just look at my, you know, product development engineering team. Um, we're at about what 16 people. Uh, that's probably pretty average for fully loaded salary. And then if I look at my annual tool and for cost, it's probably close to one, right? So then I have in these numbers, then I can calibrate it. You know, am I saying for multiplier? How defensible is this? I can be conservative and then I can then also look at my adoption rates share of engineers using AI and boost it up or boost it down. Um and then I can look at what gates. So I have small batches. I have an internal plat. It's not internal platform. I have healthy data. Um so I can kind of look at that. And so then it gives me a some math on the side that says okay I can expect roughly a 2x multiplier.

00:10:50

Andrew Kumar: Um here's my gross annual value. So it just makes some estimates on how AI can provide ROI. Um, and then I've added in some fun things like I can name the scenario, save this scenario, copy a share link, copy summary, print it, and then I have some more details here around what how the math breaks down on lift value instability kind of all the multipliers and what that net value looks like. So if I need to create a

scenario for a CTO, I send this to Z CFO sends CO shar right. So I have these different cuts and flavors and variables um that the AI has very much very handily assisted me in building. Then there a lot more information just some quick FAQs about the model and then there's a full amount of information here. What is the argument behind the numbers um so there's some I'll just jump ahead and just dust me into this part. So the methodology and sources are all here. What is baselift adoption capability multipliers scenario multipliers and then here's kind of the formula and math on the side.

00:11:50

Andrew Kumar: Um here's where the numbers come from. So you can see we are deriving it from the different figures in the door report um to to provide that. And then a bit of a caveat there. Um Ryan, you asked me like, okay, this leans quite heavily on the door report. So there was a section here of like what is ours, what what was derived from the MACH alliance versus what is arrived derived from DORA. And then um there's also a bit of information coming from Anthropic. So there's a mix and match of sources here. Um and then but ultimately it's it's it's pretty it's pretty visual. Um so there's kind of the MACH thesis composable enterprises are the ones that are getting to consequ consequential error ROI. Um and then the agent spectrum there's kind of different spectrums. Am I assisted? Am I directed? Is are the agents task oriented? Are they autonomous? Are they self-directed? So that's kind of a bit of a maturity model on the agent spectrum.

00:12:45

Andrew Kumar: Then from the working group the different adoption stages around pilot scale enterprisewide and where where the where how those organizations are stack rank based on where they are in the model um this notion of pilot problems and getting beyond the pilot and there's some data there and then some information on uh the five services four lenses so these are the four lenses the CEO CFO CTO CEO that

were identified in the dorm metric but then there's five different lenses that those those stakeholders look at around cost efficiency productivity developer experience user experience, business growth. Um, and then this JC curve comes straight out of the um, Dora metric and it's but in this AI model now it's the DOR report was very static. This one we now have a bit more animation. So you can see if you're in a pilot you're here. If you're scaled you're here when you're agent native. And that's really where you start to see the the um improvements. This one the landscape of AI impact. So the red ones are bad, the blue ones are good.

00:13:43

Andrew Kumar: So you can and so this is again just building on top of what was in the door report but adding a lot more flavor around and interact interactivity. Um so if you're thinking about delivery outcomes right so there have been a lot of reports and data around software delivery instability or friction in uh when the AI is added into an organization. there have been some friction around burnouts for people um and then there's some improvements on organizational performance or product performance um and then some uh improvements on individual effectiveness. So it's a pretty you know honest cut of where there are changes and some of those changes are good and some of those changes are bad and we just need to be aware and recognize that from a AI perspective. So there's a bit more of the caveat. Um and then again this does focus quite a bit on software engineering. I don't know if there's as much data available in market that I've seen on other roles, but I'm sure it's coming. Um, some more information on the data behind the shift, ROI, maturity, and adoption.

00:14:45

Andrew Kumar: Um, and then this is kind of a little bit more of uh kind of following the different threads or or trends. So, if I'm focused on deployment frequency, here's my stack trace. which I'm focused on developer experience here my stack trace So, a little

bit of a breakdown um of the nodes that break down each of those different items. And then, oh, there's a lot here. Yeah. And this identic mesh can probably

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. So, so I'll jump in and maybe maybe create space here for uh and there's a lot of

Andrew Kumar: remove

Everett Zufelt: information here and I think it's really good and I mean I know we've seen at Orium a lot of the same things you're calling out. Uh and I and I also agree there's things that are good, there's things that are bad. There's there's things that are bad for now because you know people haven't figured out how to make them good yet, right? Like it's not a bad forever necessarily thing. Uh, but maybe create space for the group thoughts or reactions or questions for for Andrew about what he's pulled together here.

00:15:45

Dylan Valade: First of all, this is really um impressive to see what what's possible, what we can create. Uh, and it feels like there's probably five or six different articles here and the the amount of content like so that uh kind of like the so what or what do I need to know that part isn't coming out for me. But I think this is the right type of information to be sharing. And I really like the calculator concept and the views of the different kind of the different functions of the organization. I think that's a nice way to slice it because in reality that's kind of how people procure and buy these services and operate. So overall I think this is great. It is very visual especially ever. I'm curious how you

Everett Zufelt: it it's very over I I feel it's very overwhelming but not the visual aspect just like you said there's because there's so much going on I I do think there's an opportunity a to have it turn into more than one thing and then b the the why why am I looking at it part But I think it could actually be two or three or four really, really strong pieces of content that are framed

00:17:04

Andrew Kumar: Cool. Yeah. And I'm open to feedback. This was a a very much a first volley and then I want to, you know, resize it, redice it, improve it, dissect it, modify it to see how we get it to a a state that is effective. So

Jessica Dvoretz: I think it's uh really impressive and definitely helpful in envisioning where we could go.

Andrew Kumar: yeah,

Jessica Dvoretz: I guess my question is is there a way we can take it beyond software development because I think a lot of what we're talking to clients about are like agenic use cases and how to understand the value of embedding use cases in solving business problems. Um and and which is an and I think to what you've got here and but kind of maybe something where there's less out there and they're potentially Therefore, value also harder to put

Andrew Kumar: Yep.

Jessica Dvoretz: together.

Andrew Kumar: I think that's something to consider. I think it's depending on the data sources. Um I'm not sure. So that's a TBD.

00:18:11

Ryan Lunka: Um yeah,

Andrew Kumar: But I think Ryan, your hands up, so I was going to pass to you next. Oh yeah.

Ryan Lunka: I mean most of my most my feedback is agrees so far. Like I mean I think you did a great job incorporating the first round of feedback on this and like I really like the the lenses for the different sea level stakeholders. I think that's an important angle that most people don't do a good job hitting. Um, I think the calculator itself, I think the the data backing the calculations aside for a second, I think the experience of the calculator itself makes sense to me and I like I think it's hitting the right parameters so

to speak. My my question before I actually provide the feedback is along what Jessica brought up. Are you using the Dora metrics report to generalize those numbers to agentic deployment broadly or are you intending to use the dora report as the baseline because you're focused on software engineering as the main use case. Those are it is very heavily built around agentic coding.

00:19:11

Andrew Kumar: So yeah.

Ryan Lunka: That's why I want to make sure we're clear what we're actually doing with that.

Andrew Kumar: Yeah. So it's kind of a neither option or A or B. It's I you because the DOR metrics is is available and it exists. I can use that to put into the calculator and make estimations on software engineering. So I don't that's like that it just um if we can find a like a a published source on something that's not software development focused then we can kind of ingest that back into the calculator and start to carve out you know here's the impact on software development versus the impact on GPM

Ryan Lunka: She

Andrew Kumar: roles or other roles in an organization. uh it's just it's so that that's so I haven't intentionally built it in this way. It's just because the data is there for software engineering. I can build the calculator for software engineering. If we have data on the other roles and resources then I'm I'm confident we can build the calculator on the other as

00:20:03

Ryan Lunka: Okay.

Andrew Kumar: well. It's just I didn't have that input and yeah and I can't find that input actually.

Ryan Lunka: So, makes sense. Yeah. I mean, sure, it's light and like anybody can build a calculator on somebody else's data available of of variable quality. I think there's a lot more valuable tool value in this tool and this marketing campaign for the imperfect word if it can be underlied by um a unique data set or a unique perspective that Mach is able to generate versus just restating somebody else's. So that's where I think we need to push into the mock organization to say what information would we actually need to create a unique opinionated um framework for ROI to underly this user experience and then mock team go get it Because need to create a unique asset here and that's got to be the core to it. Otherwise, um at best we're restating somebody else's analysis. At worst, Mark's going to get sued.

Everett Zufelt: is is the thought then maybe like just kind of gathering some of what I heard maybe uh and pariting back I think very good, very deep, very com complex probably could serve several valuable pieces of content maybe for because just of what data is available because I think that is a big question.

00:21:37

Everett Zufelt: Maybe focusing this in on the software engineering world for the moment for like V1 is probably uh something I think maybe nobody said directly but I'm inferring from some of the comments that were said. Uh and then I think how do we like what is the what is the reason we're telling this story? And I think that's just part of the, you know, part of the framing in each one of those pieces of content. Like I I I do think because all of this is so new, um, one of the things I try to remember when I'm creating content for mock or other is um, a lot of us spend a lot of our day thinking about AI and agents and most of the end users and people in the mock community spend a tiny little fraction of their day thinking about it. So even if we're just making something more digestible, um I actually there's merit to us doing that at this phase of maturity in the market. I don't I would love us to have data that's unique to us, but also the market is so uninformed and uneducated on a lot of these things that just making it easier to consume um probably is an okay thing for the next few quarters.

00:22:54

Everett Zufelt: So, Andrea, does that help you have some next steps on where to take this?

Andrew Kumar: Yeah. Yeah. Um I'm also I think it Yeah. I think that so again simplifying the message or or maybe spreading it out so that it's easier to consume. Um and I'm open to suggestions on that. And then the other part is data, right? Uh Ryan if you can bring up quick. I don't think Google's gonna mind too much, but we are very much heavily relying on the door report and so um and because we would pro maybe if we get Google as a signon partner because they're part of the MACH Alliance. Um so maybe we can work an angle of hey we're using your data. I hope you don't mind actually. Can you help promote it? And then we kind of have a a official unofficial

Ryan Lunka: Yes.

Andrew Kumar: uh checkbox that they are on board with us re re-representing their material and then tagging it back to the original report.

00:23:58

Andrew Kumar: Um, but two I think there is a I think you're right. There is not a unique data like there should be a unique data set that the MACH brings to the table that then makes this report more like more valuable. Um and I don't know ever if that's something

Ryan Lunka: Yeah, I mean I'm not and I think the even though it is agentic software development oriented I I do think there are reasonable generalizable takeaways from that data set And so, yeah, great. If Google's on board and that whole part of the story is, you know, box is checked, that's somebody else's job to figure out. Just kind of calling that out from my end. But I think there's generalizable concepts in there because on one hand, agentic software delivery is like a very specific thing and on the other hand, it's not. It's not actually that different. Um, it's just a specific task that's happening in the organization. Uh, I just I think it could be clearer about where those

generalizations are being made. Assuming this is not an agentic software delivery specific thing, which I agree with Jessica, it probably shouldn't be.

00:25:01

Ryan Lunka: I I I don't I don't think we should organize it that way. I think there's enough people who have put out content like Google about that and I think the generalizable business context is more helpful, but I think we should be clearer about how we're generalizing stuff from the door report. Um then if we were able to do that and combine it with additional studies maybe we find and or unique data sets for MACH now you've got something that's really really

Everett Zufelt: So,

Ryan Lunka: substantive.

Everett Zufelt: I'll I'll move us on to the next piece. This is really good, Andrew. And maybe Rebecca, you and Andrew and I could sink around next steps just to make sure like we can maybe fold in some of the marketing team and others from the alliance to make sure like and uh and that Andrew has like the support he needs so that it's not just him out there trying to build a thing,

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: but that we've got a a a system in place to make sure we get some of these ideas out the door and into the hands of the community.

00:25:53

Everett Zufelt: Um my my thought is Yeah.

Rebecca Lyus: That's just sorry every just before we go on to the next section do

Everett Zufelt: Go ahead.

Rebecca Lyus: I do just want to make a note that we do have a new person who has joined us and we haven't explained our working group we just went full steam ahead into agent adoption because we're very excited about what we're doing but hello Petro it's lovely for you to join us uh as you can tell we're very excited very keen about all these different things. I just didn't want you to go unnoticed and hells uh and if you want we can do a quick what the agent adoption and operations group is doing at the moment if that's okay with you Everett.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah,

Petro Vaxevanakis: Thanks, Rebecca. I really appreciate that. And yeah,

Everett Zufelt: absolutely.

Petro Vaxevanakis: hi everyone. Petra here from Ocula Technologies, the head of marketing there. And yeah, super excited to catch up with the community here and start uh contributing as well. Uh if you could do it a tiny intro, that would be great.

00:26:54

Petro Vaxevanakis: Although I already like the vibe of working like you guys are super collaborative. Uh and from the little I understand really uh um yeah Jessica's comment about yeah being very specific on software this is also kind of thing that I was trying to understand okay why are we doing this um yeah and the rest of the conversation was really really helpful for me to understand how you guys are

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Rebecca Lyus: Yes.

Everett Zufelt: And I and I'll say that uh our working groups are truly very working. we don't we we do our very best to avoid talking about what we could be doing and we we just do uh in within these sessions which I really appreciate. um high super highlevel overview of what we're working on and then I'm happy to I'll reach out on Slack and I'm happy to chat to you a little bit more about it in detail is um at the highest level this working group was formed with a mandate of imagine an organiza imagine we had a magic wand that we could wave and give a company every agent they needed.

00:28:00

Everett Zufelt: The goal of this working group is to help organizations understand what they would have to do differently to adopt and operate those agents to get value. So it's good enough to build them and deploy them. Uh we have a whole other working group talking about that. This working group's goal is now what what do you do once you have them? How how what changes and how do you capture that value as an enterprise? Um my and then and and then uh Petro, I'll reach out on Slack and and we can put together put some time in the calendar and I can kind of walk you through where we've come from and where we're headed.

Petro Vaxevanakis: Sounds great. Thank you for

Everett Zufelt: Uh my I'd like to make a recommendation that rather than go through

Petro Vaxevanakis: that.

Everett Zufelt: the the work that that Ryan and Tim and I have been working on around assurance and governance which I is thrilling uh work to be sure uh that maybe we uh like we'll we'll maybe table that one for our next session and go into the conversation around uh the white paper that we'd like to work on together.

00:29:12

Everett Zufelt: Does that work for everybody? I just being mindful of time.

Rebecca Lyus: Sounds good. No,

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Rebecca Lyus: of course.

Everett Zufelt: Okay. So, I put together some notes. I'm going to again uh as challenging as it is for me, I'm going to try to put on my uh disinterested facilitator hat for the rest of the call uh and get you all speaking. Uh and and then what I'll offer to do is after the call I'll take the transcript and what I heard and and share back to the group what I think could be a brief I'll share back a brief for what I think this white paper can

become. Uh and then people can give feedback and and perspective on that. So I want to start by talking about the thesis. like what are we even talking about? Uh, and I and I'm going to toss something into the chat and then I just reactions, responses, questions. I figured if I tossed something up to react to, it's better than a blank sheet of paper.

00:30:13

Everett Zufelt: So, like we're not even into goal audience or any of that. Just what is the what are we writing about? So, I'll give people a moment to like read this and digest and then would love your thoughts or questions or challenges, reactions. So what are we what are we thinking about

Rebecca Lyus: I feel it makes a lot of sense because it's better to have a few agents that are very developed and are working beautifully than a hundred that aren't really working and some of them are counteracting each other. Like if you have tone of voice agents, if you have three different tone of voice agents, none of them's a real tone of voice agent then cuz they're counteracting each other. I'm just using that as an example because about to use one today.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. Other thoughts?

Jessica Dvoretz: Uh

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. Go

Jessica Dvoretz: um when you write this statement,

Everett Zufelt: ahead.

Jessica Dvoretz: are you suggesting that we advocate for the adoption of just a few agents? Because as I read it, I was I was thinking it was more what do you need to do to actually scale, which is kind of the opposite of Rebecca's take.

00:31:46

Jessica Dvoretz: So I guess it could go either

Everett Zufelt: And I and I think this is good identifying of the ambiguity.

Jessica Dvoretz: way.

Everett Zufelt: My intent is what you you will have hundreds of agents. Period. Statement. Bold statement. Your company will have hundreds of agents. Maybe you already do. What do you need to do to ensure good proper adoption, operations, and value capture?

Itay Droog: I would say it very much depends on the control and governance you want to

Ryan Lunka: Oh,

Itay Droog: have over those agents. If you provide an internal tool that allows your colleagues to create brand new

Ryan Lunka: okay.

Itay Droog: agents and then you have to somehow maintain all of those agents 100% you're going to have hundreds if not thousands of those agents. How do you govern the conversation they're having? How do you make sure that all have access to different files, topics, uh sensitive data that is not being basically molested? Uh, I would say it the the first part you should have is data

00:32:54

Everett Zufelt: What?

Itay Droog: governance and understand what is allowed to be shared utilized with those agents and then whether those agents are able to connect externally of the organization or just internal.

Everett Zufelt: Other thoughts, questions,

Ryan Lunka: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: comments.

Rebecca Lyus: Rhino will see

Ryan Lunka: I um I So the I'm going to talk this out loud. It might not come out super clean. Um, what I'm reacting to is this binary definition of agents. So, your implication there is that there is a thing called an agent and everybody knows what that is and there should be hundreds of them. And like the the problem I'm seeing with that, especially relative to where the market is in their underseing of the word agent, is that I actually don't think agents are like this binary. These things are agents. this is regular software or this is other AI. I think it's more of a spectrum. That's why I liked the maturity or the the levels that the other working group came up with to sort of define that in a less concrete or a less binary way.

00:34:14

Ryan Lunka: Um, but we're so focused on the like the piece of compute that's doing a thing and it's called an agent. It has this special word and it has this special set of rules that has to follow and it's totally different than everything else. And I I think I think that's confusing people because it's making it sound so simple. At the same time, it's also making it sound like it's this thing that nobody actually understands because nobody really does understand what an agent means. And so I'm wondering if reframing this around not you could pilot a few agents, you're going to have hundreds of them, but instead orient to the use cases to say there are there will be hundreds of use cases that are addressed in your organization, I don't have the right words here, but using agentic software as part of the solution, whether it's 100% of the solution or 10% of the solution, but the the use case is the is the primitive, not the agent as the primitive. Uh, did any of that make sense or am I just rambling

00:35:16

Everett Zufelt: It all made sense to me.

Ryan Lunka: nonsense?

Everett Zufelt: I I like So what what I I I'm trying not to say what I like. Uh I am the worst facility, by the way. Uh I what I hear you saying is the word agent is still nobody knows what it means and we know that because a bunch of people who should know what it means spent two hours debating it a few months ago and ended up on five answers.

Ryan Lunka: Just

Everett Zufelt: So we know if if that group of people can't come up with a singular answer, let's assume there isn't one. Um and then you know is is an agent an agent or is an agent a way of a system acting and whether that's a pure or capital A agent or if it's a feature in something you're using to do something like what what we know we'll have is a bunch of systems or pieces of software acting in the enterprise in non-deterministic ways that we never had before. And though that's both scary scary on the governance side,

00:36:23

Ryan Lunka: I'm in.

Everett Zufelt: but also highly valuable on the ROI side if we can help people understand how to wrangle it.

Ryan Lunka: Yeah. So I think there's two points there.

Everett Zufelt: Is that is that a good Did that capture?

Ryan Lunka: Teasing this out. What what is the orientation around the business case versus the technical deliverable?

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. Yep.

Ryan Lunka: I think I think the business case or the use case orientation first. Maybe it's the product manager in me that thinks that's how you should think,

Everett Zufelt: Yep.

Ryan Lunka: but that's that's what draws me to it. Two, uh and this is the part that might not everybody agrees with. I I think it's actually reframing agent as a quality of a software deliverable, not the thing.

Everett Zufelt: Yep. It It's the

Ryan Lunka: And the the thing that governance requires is you have this new quality that now exists on some of your software

Everett Zufelt: agentic.

Ryan Lunka: products eventually, possibly all of your software products that you have in in your ecosystem that you now have to figure out how to manage because that quality didn't exist five minutes ago.

00:37:15

Everett Zufelt: It's the qu It's the quality of agency,

Ryan Lunka: But it's not

Everett Zufelt: I think, is what you're Is that a good way of describing it?

Ryan Lunka: Yeah. Yes. Yes. That might be a controversial opinion,

Everett Zufelt: Okay.

Ryan Lunka: so I'm not even sure I agree with it yet. But like that's what's kind of bubbling out of my head as we talk about this.

Everett Zufelt: We're here. We're here to be conf We're here to do confrontational. So,

Dylan Valade: Yeah.

Ryan Lunka: There could be an Look,

Everett Zufelt: I'm I'm good with confrontational.

Ryan Lunka: I always like a confessional header for like a content piece because it gets attention.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. Yeah. Sure.

Ryan Lunka: The confrontational headline is there's no such thing as an agent.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Ryan Lunka: What?

Everett Zufelt: Now download this report that tells you how to adopt and operate them.

Jessica Dvoretz: So so being

Ryan Lunka: Right.

Dylan Valade: Heat.

Jessica Dvoretz: slightly less confrontational listening to you Ryan. I mean I think that if there have business users reading

00:37:52

Everett Zufelt: So

Jessica Dvoretz: this it is like what you what one of you said which was you know five people got in and they couldn't define an agent like that is actually more of a hook like can you define the agents in your organization do you know what they do um I think as a like CEO COO that is the thing that's really going to be like oh s*** like do I know what's going on as opposed to like the more software perspective this doesn't exist like it's just an right because they're hearing from their boards agent you know agentic agent AI um and they're not technical people and so something provocative like do you even know how many agents are being used in your organization today or kind of what is an agent like can you define an agent and where it exists those are things that might get people thinking

Ryan Lunka: Yeah.

Dylan Valade: You got me.

Ryan Lunka: I mean,

Everett Zufelt: and and I wrote down a few question prompts from that I wrote down. Do you know how many there are?

00:39:03

Everett Zufelt: Do you know what they can do? Uh, do you know who owns them? Do you know what they're costing you? Do you know what value they create?

Ryan Lunka: premise on do you know how many there are though is you have to have an understanding of what you're even looking for.

Everett Zufelt: That's absolutely.

Ryan Lunka: Right. So like

Everett Zufelt: And and I think that does go back to the quality of agency or or it's not a the

Ryan Lunka: Right.

Everett Zufelt: thing.

Jessica Dvoretz: But Ryan, I think that becomes a like a paragraph of explanation like to know to count them,

Everett Zufelt: It's

Jessica Dvoretz: you need to know what they are, right? Like because I think it's just a very technical yours is just more technical. So it depends on who the audience is.

Everett Zufelt: so I want to keep moving us. This is very helpful. um as the person who's got to put together a brief for the group. Can I move us then to who is the audience?

00:40:05

Everett Zufelt: Who who would we like the primary persona to be that gets value from this?

Dylan Valade: very interested in supporting people that has been the mock audience the whole time, which is that leader, that change agent, the person who's putting their neck on the line to help an organization take that next step. And they need to be informed. They need to be able to assess clearly what the options are in front of them and then be able to turn around and explain it and for it internally.

Everett Zufelt: Are they more I are they more technical? Or are they more businessoriented typically would you say in their dispos uh

Dylan Valade: Typically they're coming from a more technical background and they've now stepped into a

Everett Zufelt: disposition?

Dylan Valade: business facing or kind of fronting function. They're influencing the non-technical stakeholders.

Everett Zufelt: What do folks think about that as as a as a straw man? Like I I what I'm hearing is CIO my hands a decade ago, maybe five ten years ago, my hands were really dirty in in the weeds of technology.

00:41:33

Everett Zufelt: And maybe that was Wi-Fi or phone systems, not even necessarily software delivery. And now I have a business accountability to my peers in a in a leadership capacity. And though I can maybe I'm conversant, I'm I've never built an agent in my life. I don't necessarily really understand how they all work. I've got a tech background, but today my job is help help move the business forward. Is that a Is that a good way of capturing the sentiment there? What do we think about that as the

Dylan Valade: Perfect.

Jessica Dvoretz: And is is the objective of in writing for this audience to um

Everett Zufelt: audience?

Jessica Dvoretz: speak to them where they are or to help give them the language to influence others?

Everett Zufelt: What do we think?

Dylan Valade: It's a combo. I think they're they're there hunting for themselves. I we educate themselves so that they are prepared and then as much as possible if we can hand them for this is what's coming. This is a peak around the corner and here's a way to have those conversations based on the audience that you're going to go talk to next.

00:42:46

Dylan Valade: whether they're fiba or cutting heads or doing neither. They just want to be more efficient or they just want to test something new and make sure that they've accomplished that goal.

Everett Zufelt: What do we

Ryan Lunka: I think it's both. I think there's a sequence to it because in order for you to effectively communicate and implement change around it,

Everett Zufelt: think?

Ryan Lunka: you have to have a strong grasp of what it is. Teams can totally tell when their when their boss is b***** them about AI and just like paring terms they don't understand to them. like you can you can plainly see it and people get salty about it and then are resistant to adopting the thing. And so to have the CIO who is has a comfortable grasp of the concepts and a competent understanding of what the thing is even if they're not necessarily the hands-on keyboard person building it um builds the credibility such that they can communicate it through their organization. And I think I've shared this before. My thesis is that the vast majority of sea level and close to sea level people across the world are um desperately uneducated about this and will not admit that they don't understand it and will be very guarded about it.

00:43:52

Ryan Lunka: And so to the extent you can open that up for them and say here's all this stuff that you're kind of pretending you know about. So you look good in front of your board, you look good in front of your company, here's the answers now you know.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Ryan Lunka: I think there's a real opportunity for enablement there.

Everett Zufelt: And I also think the person in this role like they're getting equally as uneducated perhaps questions and probably worse orders from their from their board and leadership. It's like go do this thing and this person may not have the tool today to push back against that expectations. So, so what do we think about that that kind of we'll call it the CIO persona, but like I don't want like it to feel like it's the like this isn't the enterprise architect who's building the systems. It's the the business leader who has a background in technology whose job it is to support their organization on this

journey. uh who needs to both understand and then be able to educate and and sometimes push back against expectations from other leaders.

00:45:10

Everett Zufelt: Does that feel like the audience we want to to address here?

Dylan Valade: Yes, for

Jessica Dvoretz: I think that sounds

Tim Fernihough: I think so. And sorry guys,

Jessica Dvoretz: right.

Tim Fernihough: I'm I got whatever illness my wife has, so I've been keeping quiet and not coughing in your ear. But it it also sounds Everett, frankly, like me a year ago. Like, you know, this this is effectively the journey I've been on. Um and you know you and Nick and some other leaders at Orium are examples of the people that I have needed to have better knowledge in order to properly engage with. So my opinion is that not only would this be very useful for me if I was on the outside but your my perspective you know contributing towards it would be we like Ryan's or I think it was Ryan that said like desperate need is how I would have said I felt a year ago. So I I give a thumbs up to this mandate or to this uh narrative.

Everett Zufelt: And that and and I think that doesn't mean it doesn't also like hey if a chief digital officer grabs it it should still make sense right it's not going to have here's a code snippet showing you how to build like that's not what this artifact is right so I think other business leaders will still get value but we'll we'll focus it around this person who quite frankly everybody else is looking to for answers uh and they probably feel alone and a little bit scared.

00:46:43

Tim Fernihough: Sounds about right to me.

Everett Zufelt: Um I heard the terms uh cost cutting and IBIDA. What part of this story that we're trying to tell is about growth versus efficiency versus like if I had to give you like rule of threes, growth versus efficiency versus existential threat. What are we thinking there?

Dylan Valade: I'm

Everett Zufelt: Or let me reframe it. What's the why? Why do I care?

Dylan Valade: hearing

Everett Zufelt: Why why does my organization care about these hundreds of what did we say? Uh hundreds of systems that have the quality of agency. Why why do we care?

Dylan Valade: Um when I'm thinking about that that person that CIO let's say CIO now in general the companies that we're working with are not failing the existential threat I would say is not imminent that these are good businesses running a real company they're expected to have some some level of growth And with that, they've got a lot of levers they could pull. and one lever is adding autonomy to the processes that they've got right now.

00:48:05

Dylan Valade: And in that case, you know, like they want to have better earnings, more more revenue, some cost savings or some margin improvement. What I'd like to see is the correlation kind of Jessica was saying between like what we have in software research where it's it probably is one of the best data sets that Dora data set around productivity and business outcome at enterprise level. I guess I haven't seen anything better Andrew. So I think that probably is the right data set there. I haven't seen anything else like that. And so where you're able to actually count and measure the work of individuals contributing to the success of a broader organization and the characteristics of that organization. I think we could make some sort of a correlation there that regardless of what type of business outcome you want, these are the the types of behaviors of leadership, the types of ways of working that seem to outperform in any industry. And then now we can show that this would work whether you were shipping boxes and doing everything by hand or you had complete automation.

00:49:19

Dylan Valade: You're going to see these things are consistent. Now where you have a process you can optimize you can optimize it manually throw bodies at it or you can optimize it automatically and then where do you want to give degrees of um agency for that decision-m because you have clear ownership of the responsibility of the outcome. But if you ladder all of that up, you get good business results that a suite is going to be looking at. So at an operational level, you can see improvement in your metrics. You can hit your targets. And at an organizational level, you can ladder this up and get real movement on the big numbers that matter to

Everett Zufelt: What do we think about that

Dylan Valade: you.

Everett Zufelt: approach?

Jessica Dvoretz: I think that's the positive framing. I mean I think if we're talking about um this person in this seat they are feeling um some existential there is an existential layer potentially not to the business as a whole but to them right like if there are

Dylan Valade: That's true.

Jessica Dvoretz: agents in your business that you do not understand like what are the risks if you start rolling out agenic programs um and thinking they're going to cost X in tokens and they cost 10x in tokens that's a risk for you right so I

00:50:38

Ryan Lunka: Let's

Jessica Dvoretz: think there are some I don't know if existential is the right word but whereas

Ryan Lunka: go.

Jessica Dvoretz: aenic is an opportunity for the company kind of the person in this seat really there is risk to

Ryan Lunka: Come

Jessica Dvoretz: the person in the seat to like falling behind

Ryan Lunka: on.

Everett Zufelt: Every Every Every one of these people has heard from their board or CEO in the last six months. Why are we pay plug your ears if you're from a SAS vendor?

Ryan Lunka: It's

Everett Zufelt: Why are we paying for SAS when I read an article in Forbes that says we can just build our own

Ryan Lunka: f*****

Everett Zufelt: software? Like there's not a single CIO in an enterprise company who hasn't heard that at least one time in the last six months. Why are we still paying hundreds of thousand dollars for X? We could just build it ourselves. Here's a link to a article I found on Force. Now, I know that that's not true, but this person has to now spend time and energy and life force to deal with it.

00:51:44

Ryan Lunka: Yeah. So I definitely agree Jessica with your framing around the personal existential threat because yeah if you've built a career

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Ryan Lunka: managing technical people and then all of a sudden that like the value of that is at least going to change if not change significantly that's a like threat for your career. Um, I do think there's also, and maybe it's more meta than we want to get to in this um, white paper, but it call back to the um, Clayton Christensen conversation we had last time. Um, in order to like actually frame your thinking around AI and what you actually want to deploy and how to whether or not it's existential for your business, you do kind of have to form an opinion on whether you believe it's disruptive or sustained for your business and your industry because the actions you would take downstream of that opinion are different. Right? If you're if you believe it's it's a sustaining innovation

for your line of business, then you should be talking about cost efficiencies and you know marginal revenue improvements be basically like incrementally improving the evidence of the business using AI.

00:52:47

Ryan Lunka: If you believe that AI will fundamentally disrupt what you do, like it won't exist in 10 years, the actions you should be taking now at an enterprise level are very different, then let's just try to add a couple points of margin. And kind of forming that opinion and having a perspective on that is going to be important. But again, that's getting pretty esoteric for a white paper. So I don't know if that's what you want to do.

Everett Zufelt: Let let let me sit with those thoughts and and come back again in the brief. I'll make sure kind of I address each one of them with like some questions for the group to respond to. One bullet I dropped in on on my own is what have we all we we as a business is there a thing we've always wished we were able to do because we like to not on the existential disruption side but just on the growth side we've always known that if we could X it would be so good for our customers and our business and it's always felt impossible right are there are there things that are no longer impossible on that we've always they've just been put in a box shoved in the closet it, we're never going to do it.

00:53:55

Everett Zufelt: Are are some of those possible now? And again, I don't think that addresses the we're going to be fundamentally disrupted question, but it could be part of the, you know, hey, what's what are those levers we can pull today that we couldn't have pulled two years ago. Um, if we think back to and I just like to get a pulse from folks like if we think back to like hey these are good growing organizations you know and and probably trying to sell them a story of existential threat to the business maybe like they should ask themselves the question it probably isn't the thesis of the white

paper. Is there something worth touching on around I think last time we chatted about innovator's dilemma which is it's not an existential threat until it is an existential threat and then you really wish you had have seen it coming. Is it worth touching on that or is this audience in 2026 not ready to embrace that?

Ryan Lunka: That's what I'm advocating for. Um,

Everett Zufelt: Okay.

Ryan Lunka: one of the key one of the key takeaways from that book and from that theory

00:54:58

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Ryan Lunka: is understanding whether a technology is sustaining or disruptive.

Everett Zufelt: Got

Ryan Lunka: Because if you treat it like it's a sustaining innovation,

Everett Zufelt: it.

Ryan Lunka: but it's actually disruptive, that's how you, you know, fall apart in the long

Everett Zufelt: Let's So let's let's maybe fold that under that.

Ryan Lunka: run.

Everett Zufelt: How how would you know? How might you start to sense if this if this is actually disruptive to you? We obviously we can't answer that for people, but we can maybe point them at things where they can think about the answer for themselves.

Ryan Lunka: It's a big question.

Everett Zufelt: Um,

Ryan Lunka: That's a \$600 an hour consulting

Everett Zufelt: yeah,

Ryan Lunka: question,

Everett Zufelt: sign up here for the MACH alliance.

Ryan Lunka: which I'll gladly open an SNW for if anybody's

Everett Zufelt: Uh, I'm just skimming through.

Ryan Lunka: interested.

Everett Zufelt: We have five minutes left. I'm just skimming through my other question. Culture. Maybe I'll ask what what and how much do we want to include in here about people and culture?

00:56:16

Dylan Valade: I think it's the piece of the puzzle that a lot of people don't understand just how big of an impact it has on the type of organization that ships software quickly.

Ryan Lunka: It's

Dylan Valade: And at the end of the day, this is software that we're talking about.

Ryan Lunka: awesome.

Dylan Valade: Um, and until they could understand that their organization just isn't capable, they might not understand why their pilots are failing. But you could quickly diagnose it if you have seen a different type of environment. And that's something that sometimes the consulting agency external partner brings is that they already have a con a culture that allows them to ship software fast. And so they can come in and quickly do something that the organization has failed at for years.

Ryan Lunka: Thank you very

Dylan Valade: So,

Ryan Lunka: much.

Dylan Valade: it's a diagnostic that that CIO might want for themselves to know if this is something they could accomplish on their own or if they're organization just wouldn't be able to do it or at least not competitively

Everett Zufelt: Other thoughts or perspectives on that?

00:57:26

Jessica Dvoretz: Um, again, this I guess I sound like a broken record, but are we talking about the culture in the software development org or kind of the

Dylan Valade: beyond that the whole organization. Yeah.

Jessica Dvoretz: culture

Dylan Valade: The so let's say for example what was it? Go ship AI make make agents happen. Um we've been unsuccessful at getting the new phone system out. We've been unsuccessful at adopting a CRM. We've been unsuccessful at insert any other technology expected to be used enterprisewide and gain efficiency. Why would this be any different? In fact, it's more complex. So that that more the culture accepting new change in how ready are we

Everett Zufelt: Yeah.

Dylan Valade: how good are we at helping the organization to scale up as opposed to scare the hell out of people. Um that existential threat becomes more real when you have a culture that makes everyone feel uncomfortable.

Everett Zufelt: And flip fl flip side if I put the CFO hat on. I'm paying \$300 a year for 3,000 people to have access to co-pilot.

00:58:30

Everett Zufelt: Uh so whatever that is 9,9 900 Oh my god, that's a big number. N a million bucks a year for people to have access to co-pilot. What the hell? Like should I just turn it off? Is anybody using it? Do they know how to use it? Can somebody point to me where we're getting our million dollars back? Ideally, where we're getting \$5 million back? Like I think those are some of the big questions around people and culture like how do we adopt? How do we show the value that of adoption? And then maybe some of the like who moved my cheese like I am now terrified that you know I'm 55 years old and will never be employable again.

Jessica Dvoretz: I think that's a big one is um is kind of right that there's this mandate or you know we're being told to give people licenses or there's an agitation and from below for these licenses, but kind of how do how do I make sure we're getting something for that? I think there's just a huge sticker shock.

00:59:35

Jessica Dvoretz: Um,

Everett Zufelt: huge.

Jessica Dvoretz: and kind of what other steps do I need to take to make sure I'm getting the

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. And these companies are so good like Anthropic with their giving us the 50% boost

Jessica Dvoretz: ROI

Everett Zufelt: on the weekly usage that gets cut off tomorrow. And now, you know, I'm all like groov grooving at that fifth. I've been using over 100% of that and now tomorrow it's going to cost me 50% overage if I want to keep behaving the same way. Right? These these companies are not stupid about how they extract dollars from our wallets either.

Jessica Dvoretz: Correct. And they're going public, so it's only

Everett Zufelt: It's only going to get it's only going to get worse. All right. So So we're at time. I this was really really helpful to me as the person who's going to put a brief together. So my next step I'm going to go back through the transcript. I'm going to take all the notes and conversations. I'm going to put together a brief for the white paper. I'll drop it into the Slack channel. My hope is in the next couple of days. Uh and then just uh you know challenge it, question it, challenge it, comment on it. Uh and we'll get it into a shape where we all feel good about moving it forward together.

Jessica Dvoretz: Right.

Dylan Valade: This is a good discussion.

Rebecca Lyus: All

Dylan Valade: Thank you.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah, this was nice. This is fun. All right, have a great week, everyone.

Jessica Dvoretz: You too.

Rebecca Lyus: right. Speak to you later.

Petro Vaxevanakis: Bye everyone.

Rebecca Lyus: Hey

Transcription ended after 01:01:14

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